

Oct 17, 2025

Meeting Oct 17, 2025 at 15:45 CEST

Meeting records  Recording

Summary

The meeting focused on building and refining an AI agent workflow for job applications, led by Clément Lacaille. Naim Burrack volunteered to present the workflow, which involved using Perplexity for context, filtering job postings, and configuring an AI agent for research and output generation. Key discussions included troubleshooting code node issues, optimizing AI agent outputs for resumes and cover letters, and integrating with Google Sheets, with Clément Lacaille providing direct guidance to participants like Naim Burrack, Julius-Jonas Steffen, and Murphy Odion Usunobun on various technical challenges.

Details

Notes Length: Standard

- **Volunteer for Presentation** Clément Lacaille asked for a volunteer to present the workflow for the class, specifically someone who had not presented before. Naweed Zahed initially declined, citing absence from the previous day's session. Naim Burrack, having discussed workflows with classmates, volunteered to present and continue the workflow.
- **Perplexity Pro Discount** Shivashanti_ inquired about a student discount for Perplexity. Naim Burrack shared that they obtained a key for Perplexity Pro for a year for \$1 and mentioned finding deals on specific websites, such as a German deal forum offering a free one-year subscription for PayPal users.
- **Workflow Context for AI Agent** Clément Lacaille guided Naim Burrack to start building a workflow by first asking the AI agent (Perplexity) to decipher the

context of the workflow. Naim Burrack was instructed to download a JSON file of the current workflow and upload it to Perplexity, asking the AI agent to understand its contents. This method was identified as a more effective way to provide context than screenshots alone.

- **Refining Job Search Criteria** Clément Lacaille asked Naim Burrack to narrow down job postings to a manageable number, suggesting two or three jobs, to avoid a lengthy workflow explanation. Naim Burrack was asked to filter jobs based on parameters such as location (Cologne) and upload date (last 7 days), leading to a much shorter list.
- **Implementing Code Node** Clément Lacaille instructed Naim Burrack to use a code node in N8N to filter the job postings based on the refined criteria, explaining that the process involves pasting the previous JSON output into Perplexity and asking for the filtering code. Naim Burrack demonstrated how to add a code node and execute it, successfully narrowing the results to a single item, which was deemed ideal for the current learning phase.
- **Setting up AI Agent for Research** Clément Lacaille guided Naim Burrack on setting up an AI agent for researching companies and job postings. They selected the "define below" option for the prompt source, allowing manual definition of the message or criteria, and then instructed the AI agent to use OpenAI and Perplexity as research tools.
- **Defining Research Information** Naim Burrack provided specific information points for the AI agent to research about companies, including values, culture, recent news, funding rounds, product launches, tech stack, and employee reviews/ratings. For job postings, Naim Burrack specified required skills like Python programming and Django, and a desired monthly salary range of 1,800 to 2,400 euros. Clément Lacaille emphasized that these details should be customized by each user for their own needs.
- **Configuring AI Model and Output Format** Clément Lacaille instructed Naim Burrack to configure the AI agent to use GPT-4o or GPT-4 as the chat model and to set the response format to JSON object for structured output. Clément Lacaille also clarified that smaller models like GPT-4o are faster, use fewer tokens, and are more cost-effective compared to larger models for simpler tasks.
- **Integrating Perplexity as a Tool** Naim Burrack initially encountered an issue when trying to add Perplexity as a tool within the AI agent, leading to an incorrect configuration. Clément Lacaille advised asking Perplexity directly for guidance on

how to set up the Perplexity tool within the agent. After some troubleshooting, it was discovered that Perplexity's "magic wand" feature allows the AI model to define parameters automatically, simplifying the setup process for certain nodes.

- **AI Agent System and User Messages** Naim Burrack was instructed to set the system message for the AI agent, defining its role as an "expert job application research assistant". The user message was set to "Research this job opportunity thoroughly," prompting the AI agent to gather the detailed information specified earlier. Clément Lacaille clarified that users can modify these messages to fit their specific research requirements, using Perplexity to re-write prompts based on their desired criteria.
- **Workflow Execution and Results** The workflow was executed, demonstrating the AI agent calling both OpenAI and Perplexity tools to conduct research. The AI agent successfully identified details about the target company, including required skills (PHP, JavaScript, React, TypeScript, Docker, SQL), and provided an annual salary range and career development opportunities, which Naim Burrack found helpful despite the job not fully aligning with their Python and Django skills.
- **Troubleshooting User Message Issues** Julius-Jonas Steffen reported that their user message prompt in the N8N window was not fully recognized. Clément Lacaille guided them to copy the complete JSON output from the previous node and paste it into Perplexity along with their user message, asking Perplexity to rewrite the user message to match the JSON structure. This resolved the recognition issue, enabling the user message to work correctly within the workflow.
- **Adjusting System Message** Clément Lacaille guided Julius-Jonas Steffen through refining a system message to exclude undesired search results like "salary" and to always end queries with a clarification prompt. They confirmed the revised system message contained sufficient context, allowing them to proceed with executing the step and observing the tool's function.
- **Reviewing Output and Seeking Feedback** Clément Lacaille reviewed the initial output, which included company size, employee ratings, and salary range, deeming it acceptable but noted that users could request more information if needed. Clément then asked for a thumbs-up from participants to gauge how many had completed the task, noting that Julius-Jonas Steffen and Murphy Odion Usunobun had finished, while others, like Murphy Odion Usunobun, indicated they were still working.

- **Sharing JSON Files and API Keys** Naim Burrack inquired about sharing their JSON file to help others catch up, but Sven Lück clarified that API keys are not shared if stored in credentials. Clément Lacaille expressed reluctance about sharing solutions directly, preferring participants to struggle and learn, and offered individual help instead.
- **Debugging Murphy Odion Usunobun's Workflow** Clément Lacaille guided Murphy Odion Usunobun through troubleshooting their AI agent workflow, starting with verifying the system message and copying JSON data from the previous node. They collaboratively worked on rewriting the user message to match the JSON structure, despite initial difficulties and syntax issues, by repeatedly trying to correct the input.
- **Correcting Data Input Method** Clément Lacaille instructed Murphy Odion Usunobun to directly drag and drop column headers from the table into the user message field, ensuring each column was entered row-wise with proper spacing. They also addressed an issue with the chat model, guiding Murphy Odion Usunobun to select "chat GPT4 latest" to ensure proper functionality.
- **Troubleshooting API and Workflow Execution** Murphy Odion Usunobun's workflow encountered an "unauthorized" error, which Clément Lacaille identified as an incorrect API key. After providing a correct API key, the workflow began functioning properly.
- **Checking Participant Progress and Offering Support** Clément Lacaille again checked on the participants' progress, with Naweed Zahed and Francesca Erica Cerza indicating they were not on track due to missing parts of the class. Clément offered continued support through Slack and encouraged everyone to practice the workflow on their own.
- **Setting Up a New AI Agent for Resume and Cover Letter Generation** Clément Lacaille directed Naim Burrack to set up a new AI agent, which they named "resume writer," to generate customized resumes and cover letters using gathered job details and the applicant's resume. They connected the new agent to the merged data, ensuring all relevant information was available for the task.
- **Troubleshooting and Optimizing AI Agent Output** Clément Lacaille guided Naim Burrack on configuring the AI agent's chat model, setting the maximum tokens to 8,000 to ensure a comprehensive response. They also emphasized the importance of the system and user messages in guiding the AI, aiming to refine the output of the cover letter and resume generation.

- Separating Resume and Cover Letter Outputs** Clément Lacaille and Naim Burrack aimed to separate the resume and cover letter outputs into distinct JSON columns using a code node. Naim Burrack then attempted to debug a syntax error in the code, with Clément Lacaille suggesting trying the code again and exploring alternative methods for structuring the output.
- Addressing Output Formatting Issues** Clément Lacaille addressed persistent issues with the code node by suggesting an alternative approach: requesting the AI agent to produce a specific output format directly within the system message. Leon Winde also suggested adding a structured output parser node to ensure JSON output.
- Final Adjustments and Continued Support** Clément Lacaille guided Naim Burrack to update the system message to request separate JSON outputs for the resume and cover letter, hoping to resolve the formatting issues without additional code. Clément also offered to stay after the meeting to help participants complete their workflows.
- Code Node and JSON Output Issues** Naim Burrack faced issues with the code node and JSON output, leading to multiple attempts at troubleshooting. Clément Lacaille guided them to remove the initial code node and then the structured parser node, and also suggested trying to run the agent again.
- Troubleshooting Resume and Cover Letter Customization** Naim Burrack struggled to correctly drag and drop elements for customizing the resume and cover letter. Clément Lacaille advised them to manually write "customize resume" and "cover letter" instead of relying on the drag-and-drop feature, in order to progress.
- Agent Output and System Message Refinement** The agent's output for the cover letter and resume was deemed "funny" by Naim Burrack due to the differing job positions. Clément Lacaille directed them to copy the output JSON and provide more specific instructions to the agent for separating the resume, cover letter, and skills to emphasize.
- Using Deep Research and Code Node for Solution** To resolve the parsing issues, Clément Lacaille instructed Naim Burrack to use the "deep research" button and then set up a new code node based on the suggested solution. This aimed to generate the proper code for separating content.

- **Connecting to Google Sheets** Naim Burrack encountered difficulties connecting to Google Sheets, initially forgetting to save their credentials and then having trouble with the document list. Clément Lacaille guided them through creating new credentials, saving them, and correctly selecting the spreadsheet for the workflow.
- **Workflow Completion and Follow-up** Naim Burrack successfully completed the workflow by appending rows to a Google Sheet, although the output quality was noted to be improvable with further customization. Clément Lacaille requested Naim Burrack to post a screenshot of their progress on the Slack group and offered further assistance to others.
- **Student Progress Check-in** Clément Lacaille checked in with other participants like Cecilia Mwaniki, Leon Winde, and Chinedu Kirian Onwuzuruike to assess their progress, acknowledging that many were still catching up on previous classes or working on different parts of the assignment.
- **Introduction to Future Topics** Clément Lacaille previewed the topics for the following week, which include building voice agents with Level Labs and understanding vector databases. They emphasized the exciting possibilities of these advanced concepts, such as creating personal assistants and automating queries with front-end integrations like Telegram.
- **Discussion on Learning and Career Impact** Participants discussed the value of the learned skills, acknowledging that while there was a learning curve, the flexibility and broad applicability of automation tools make them a valuable asset for careers and even potential businesses. Naim Burrack and Naweed Zahed shared their personal experiences and enthusiasm for applying these skills to their own job applications.
- **Julius-Jonas Steffen's Workflow Progress** Julius-Jonas Steffen presented their screen, demonstrating a customized workflow where their AI successfully generated cover letters, subjects, and email bodies for two different companies, with key points highlighted. They were in the process of setting up the Google Sheet integration for their output.
- **Troubleshooting Google Sheets for Julius-Jonas Steffen** Julius-Jonas Steffen faced issues with the Google Sheets integration, as the correct sheet was not appearing in the dropdown list. Clément Lacaille guided them to delete the existing Google Sheet node and create a new spreadsheet, which resolved the issue and allowed them to successfully append rows.

Suggested next steps

- ☐ Naweed Zahed will watch the recording to set up the class and ask Clément Lacaille any questions on Monday or via Slack.
- ☐ Francesca Erica Cerza will complete the work with the recording and ask Clément Lacaille for assistance if needed.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will ask Clement to post another form in the Slack channel tomorrow or Monday and update the group.
- ☐ Naim Burrack will copy and paste the system message and the structured output JSON code, along with a screenshot, in the Slack group.
- ☐ Naim Burrack will try writing a cover resume and an actual resume.
- ☐ Naim Burrack will let Sven Lück know if he tries out Python in N8N.
- ☐ Julius-Jonas Steffen will post the status on the Slack group about what he built today and save the workflow for later use.

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